



Money Basics Course Pilot Outcomes

The pilot run of Money Basics was held for eight weeks between April 19, 2012 and June 7, 2012, with a graduation celebration on June 14, 2012.

The class was advertised through a number of locations throughout the Portland area, which included Multnomah County, Washington County, and Clackamas County. With the goal of targeting individuals for participation who identify as having experienced mental health challenges, we advertised primarily through various mental health and social service clinics. Through these avenues, we presented to providers during team meetings or directly to the clients during community meetings or therapeutic groups. We held the class in a general meeting room at a local mental health clinic.

Eighteen individuals registered for the course. A total of twelve individuals attended at least one class.

The following table illustrates the attendance through the course:

Class	Total attendance	Class	Total attendance
4/19/2012	9	5/17/2012	7
4/26/2012	9	5/24/2012	6
5/03/2012	6	5/31/2012	8
5/10/2012	6	6/7/2012	7

During the first attended class, all class participants were asked to complete a demographics form.

Through the demographics form, we gathered the following information about the class participants:

Average participant age	40.5
Female registrants	13
Male registrants	5
Female participants	7
Male participants	5
Total participants (who attended at least one class)	12
Participants receiving SSI or SSDI benefits	8
Participants who had a representative payee (at time of first attended class)	4
Participants who had a checking account (at time of first attended class)	7
Participants who had a savings account (at time of first attended class)	7

From the beginning of the course to the last class, where some similar information was gathered, there were no changes reported for the status of having checking accounts, savings accounts, or representative payees. However, participants who reported having no checking account or savings account, or having a representative payee at the time of their first attended class, discussed action plans to address these areas with the class facilitators before the conclusion of the course.

Eleven participants also completed a pre-class questionnaire during their first attended class, with statements they were asked to rate numerically. Upon completion of the course, eight participants were completed a post-class questionnaire, with identical statements from the pre-class questionnaire.

The numerical ratings for the statements in both questionnaires were as follows:

5 = Totally agree

4 = Somewhat agree

3 = Neither agree nor disagree

2 = Somewhat disagree

1 = Totally disagree

Statement	Average Pre-class Rating	Average Post-class Rating
Overall, I feel confident in my ability to manage my finances.	3.9	4.1
I feel comfortable opening my mail as soon as I get it.	2.8	3.8
Money issues rarely negatively affect my mental health.	3.5	2.6
I feel confident that any mental health challenges I may face will not negatively affect my finances.	2.8	3
I rarely live paycheck to paycheck.	1.8	2
I feel able to save money to achieve my goals.	2.4	4
I maintain a budget that works for me.	2.1	3.3
I feel that I have the tools and skills to keep my money safe.	2.4	4.1
I have a plan to pay off my debt(s). (Or – I have no current debts.)	3	3.1
I understand how credit works.	2.8	4.1
Average ratings for all statements:	2.7	4.2
Total ratings for all statements:	27.5	34.1

This demonstrates an increase in average ratings from pre-class to post-class questionnaires for all statements of 1.5, and an overall combined rating increase of 6.6.

In addition, on conclusion of the course, eight participants completed a class evaluation.

The numerical ratings for the statements in the evaluation were as follows:

4 = Totally agree

3 = Somewhat agree

2 = Somewhat disagree

1 = Totally disagree

Statement	Average rating
I found the structure of the class to be helpful.	3.6
I was comfortable with the amount of participants in the class.	3.8
The class facilitators were informative and engaging.	4
Average ratings for all statements:	3.8
Total ratings for all statements:	15.2

In the class evaluation, participants were asked to indicate which components of the course they found the most useful, and which information given during the course they found to be the most useful. They were instructed to any and all that apply.

Of the eight participants who completed the evaluations, the following table illustrates how they completed this section of the evaluation:

Component	Number*
Class sharing and updates	7
Hands-on learning	5
Group discussion	8
Break-out groups	2
Support from other class participants	6
Support from class facilitators	4
Homework assignments	4

Information	Number*	Information	Number*
Creating a Person-Directed Plan	8	Alternative banking	5
Money saving tips	6	Money safety	3
Banking	2	Debt/Getting out of debt	5
How to open a checking account	0	Bankruptcy/Pros and cons of bankruptcy	3
Credit/How credit works	4	Mental health challenges and money issues	7
Loans/Steps to paying down loans	2	Addictions & substance abuse and financial issues	3
Predatory lending	4	Relationship issues and money	6
Debit cards	2	Financial abuse	4
How to use an ATM/ATM safety	5	Savings	5

*Number of participants indicating they found the component to be useful.

The evaluation solicited three additional pieces of information from participants:

Things I liked most about the class:

- “The facilitators. They were serious about the information and understood that finances (proper management of finances) could change one’s life.”
- “Feeling part of a group; not alone. Brainstorming.”
- “Too many things to list. I enjoyed thoroughly.”
- “Discussions. All the tips.”
- “Personal. Confidential. Showing on board and putting plans on paper.”
- “The instructors. Donita and Amy, you are a good team. Two different styles which allowed us to process differently, hear things said differently, and lots of varied examples. Loved the honesty, sense of humor, and ‘go with the group’. I liked my classmates. I loved the size of the group.”
- “It addressed the things which we all deal with.”

Suggestions for change:

- “Too much information for the time allowed for program. Perhaps extending weeks of class to help participants develop money habits. Promoting more networking among participants. Expand geographic region for program. We need this class!”
- “More time to go over material.”
- “It may be you could get by on less paper.”

Additional comments:

- “Loved the teachers. Very knowledgeable.”
- Might be nice to check and see how far we reach our goals in 2015.”
- “Just taking the class causes one to be more money management minded. This class has changed my life for the better. Although I’ve had ‘no money’ days since the class I have had less stress on those days because I have been making conscious money decisions. I now have money accountability. Thank you.”
- “Spectacular presentation.”
- “I’m just glad to participate.”
- “I had a great time. Learned a lot.”

A monetary incentive was used for maximum participation in the class. Participants who attended at least six of the eight classes received a \$25.00 gift card. Participants who attended at least seven of the eight classes were entered into a drawing to potentially receive an additional \$50.00 gift card.

Upon conclusion of the course:

- 5 participants attended 6 classes
- 1 participant attended 7 classes
- 2 participants attended 8 classes

The course ended with eight graduates.